ALLY WEALTH • AUTHOR VISIBILITY CONSULTANT

The Author Branding Workbook

Clarify your author identity, reader promise and consistent public presence.

A practical workbook and reference guide

EDUCATIONAL RESOURCE • 2026 EDITION

How to use this guide

Author branding is the deliberate presentation of an author's work, perspective and relationship with readers. It is not a demand to perform a false personality or to be present on every platform. This workbook uses reflective exercises to help create a clear, credible and sustainable identity.

Work through the pages in order. Use the prompts to make decisions, record assumptions and identify actions. You can revisit a page when your book, audience or publishing plan changes.

Keep the work evidence-aware. Platform interfaces, policies and marketplace features change. Verify current official guidance before acting on platform-specific instructions. Treat examples as planning aids, not guarantees.

Make it your own. Not every tactic belongs in every campaign. Choose the actions that fit your book, resources, readers and values.

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01 / FIELD GUIDE

Separate author identity from book identity

A single title has its own promise; an author may have a broader body of work. Decide which parts of your identity should remain consistent and which should change with genre, subject or audience.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **separate author identity from book identity**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

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Identify your creative centre

Write about the themes, questions, subjects or emotional territory that repeatedly draw you to write. Look for patterns without forcing every project into one label.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **identify your creative centre**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Describe your intended readers

Think about what readers value, what they hope to feel or learn and what makes them trust an author. Avoid defining readers only by age or demographic shorthand.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **describe your intended readers**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Write your author promise

Complete: ‘Readers who come to my work can expect…’ Make the statement specific, credible and flexible enough to remain true across your books.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **write your author promise**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Choose three brand pillars

Select three themes that can guide content and communication. They might include craft, subject expertise, imagination, research, community or a recurring theme in your work.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **choose three brand pillars**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Define your voice

Choose a few descriptors for your public writing voice and explain what they mean in practice. For example, warm may mean conversational and generous; authoritative may mean precise and evidence-aware.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **define your voice**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Create a short biography

Write a concise bio that prioritises relevant work, subject connection and a human detail you are comfortable sharing. Avoid inflated claims and unnecessary life history.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **create a short biography**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Create a long biography

Prepare a longer version for interviews, events or media kits. Keep the same facts and tone as the short bio, expanding only where useful.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **create a long biography**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Choose visual direction

Select colours, type styles, image mood and layout principles that suit your genre and personality. The goal is consistency and legibility, not a rigid template for every project.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **choose visual direction**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Plan author photography

Decide whether you need a portrait and where it will be used. Choose images that feel current and professional, obtain usage rights and prepare crops for different platforms.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **plan author photography**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Build a consistent author profile

Review profile names, bios, links and images across the channels you use. Make it easy for a reader to recognise the same author and find the next step.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **build a consistent author profile**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Clarify your platform boundaries

Decide what you will share, what remains private and how much time you can give each channel. Boundaries make a public presence more sustainable.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **clarify your platform boundaries**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
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Working notes

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Choose channels deliberately

Compare audience fit, format, time demands and accessibility. Start with one or two channels you can maintain rather than opening accounts everywhere.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **choose channels deliberately**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
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Working notes

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Create recurring content themes

Develop repeatable themes that connect to your work: research notes, craft insights, reading recommendations, setting or subject context and reader questions. Share only what you are comfortable making public.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **create recurring content themes**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Tell your book’s story

Explain the origin, central question or creative challenge behind a book without revealing private information or spoiling key moments. Keep the reader’s curiosity at the centre.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **tell your book’s story**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Present expertise responsibly

If your books draw on professional or specialist knowledge, distinguish personal experience from formal qualifications and evidence. Link to reliable sources when making factual claims.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **present expertise responsibly**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
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Working notes

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Develop a media sheet

Create a concise document with bio, book details, approved images, interview topics, links and contact route. Update it when book information changes.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **develop a media sheet**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Make your website useful

Include a clear introduction, books, biography, relevant news or resources and a contact route. Prioritise mobile readability, accessibility and accurate information.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **make your website useful**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Connect the author and catalogue

Help readers move from one book to another through series order, related themes and clear links. Avoid suggesting that unrelated titles belong together when they do not.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **connect the author and catalogue**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Build reader trust

Be accurate, respectful and consistent. Correct mistakes openly, honour commitments and avoid manufactured intimacy or pressure tactics.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **build reader trust**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
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Working notes

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Plan newsletter value

If you use email, offer a clear reason to subscribe and send only what readers have consented to receive. Useful content can include updates, reading notes or behind-the-scenes context.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **plan newsletter value**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Create a sustainable publishing rhythm

Set a realistic frequency for updates and content. Choose a minimum viable cadence that can survive busy writing periods.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **create a sustainable publishing rhythm**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Handle public feedback

Decide how to respond to praise, criticism, errors and difficult messages. You do not need to answer every comment; maintain boundaries and correct material inaccuracies calmly.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **handle public feedback**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Protect privacy and safety

Avoid sharing sensitive personal details, private addresses, travel plans or information about other people without permission. Review account security and moderation settings.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **protect privacy and safety**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
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Working notes

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Keep brand elements flexible

A brand should support new work, not trap the author. Review it when genre, audience or creative direction changes, while keeping recognisable essentials.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **keep brand elements flexible**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Audit consistency

Compare your website, retailer pages, social profiles, email signature and media sheet. Correct conflicting bios, outdated links and inconsistent book titles.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **audit consistency**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Create a brand message bank

Store approved descriptions, bios, introductions, key themes and answers to common questions. Keep a dated source document so collaborators use the latest version.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **create a brand message bank**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Measure meaningful engagement

Look beyond follower totals. Consider relevant conversations, email replies, event invitations, qualified visits and readers who move from one book to another.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **measure meaningful engagement**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Refresh your author brand

Review what feels authentic, what readers understand and what no longer fits. Update selectively rather than changing every element at once.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **refresh your author brand**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Your author brand blueprint

Summarise your promise, audience, pillars, voice, visuals, channels, boundaries and next actions in one usable reference.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **your author brand blueprint**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

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Working notes